

1. Emergence Phase

1.1 Intent Statement

- **PROBLEM:** A significant and growing portion of the global population leads a sedentary lifestyle, a crisis accelerated by modern urban design.¹ This physical inactivity is a leading risk factor for mortality and a primary driver of noncommunicable diseases (NCDs) like heart disease, diabetes, and certain cancers, creating a massive public health burden and incurring billions in healthcare costs.²
- **AUDIENCE:** The primary audience includes the most physically inactive segments of the population, who are often deterred by the cost, culture, and intimidation of traditional gyms.⁵ This encompasses a wide demographic, including seniors focused on maintaining mobility, time-constrained parents and caregivers, and deconditioned beginners who feel self-conscious about exercising in public.⁵
- **FAILURES:** Previous efforts have often followed a passive "build it and they will come" approach, resulting in underutilized facilities. Common failures include: installing "one-size-fits-all" equipment that is too simplistic for serious users yet confusing for beginners⁷; poor placement in low-visibility or inaccessible areas⁷; inadequate maintenance leading to broken and unsafe equipment⁸; and a complete lack of programming or activation, which fails to overcome significant psychological barriers like the fear of public judgment and lack of knowledge on how to use the equipment.¹⁰
- **NEW VALUE:** To foster sustained physical activity by creating trustworthy, socially activated, and contextually integrated public environments. The core principle is to shift from passive equipment provision to a human-centered model that actively builds user confidence, social connection, and a sense of community ownership.
- **OPPORTUNITY:** Key opportunities can be leveraged, including: community-led activation models where local residents are trained to lead classes and encourage peers¹¹; the integration of smart technology like apps and digital screens to provide guidance and track usage¹³; and strategic partnerships with public health bodies, local businesses, and non-profits to co-fund initiatives and provide structured programming.¹⁴ These efforts align with the broader urban planning trend of creating "activity-friendly communities".³

- **RISK:** A primary risk is legal and financial liability stemming from injuries caused by equipment malfunction or improper use.¹² Vandalism and crime can create an unsafe environment, deterring use and increasing maintenance costs.¹⁸ If the initiative fails to engage the target audience, it risks significant underutilization, leading to a perception of wasted public funds and a loss of community trust.

1.2 Benchmarking

Initiative	Approach	Target Audience	Key Actions	Failures, Limitations, Gaps	Opportunities
Parcourse System (USA, 1980s)	A pioneering fitness trail model that installed permanent exercise stations along jogging paths. ²¹	General public, with some attempt to cater to different fitness levels.	Provided instructional signage for three distinct fitness levels: "starting, sporting, and championship". ²¹	Failure/Limitation: The model often featured equipment that was not adjustable, creating a "one-size-fits-all" problem that could be too simple for fit users and intimidating for beginners. This highlighted a core design tension that persisted for decades. ⁷	Opportunity: Its tiered instruction system was an early recognition of the need to cater to diverse users, a concept that could be vastly improved with modern technology and zoned design.

Ken Malloy Harbor Regional Park (USA)	A modern, large-scale outdoor fitness park designed with distinct, physically separated zones for different user groups and fitness levels. ²²	Multigenerational, including seniors (therapeutic zone), the general public (standard zone), and advanced athletes (elite zone). ²²	Created clearly demarcated zones with color-coded surfacing and specific equipment. Partnered with health organizations (Kaiser Permanente, YMCA) to offer free, structured classes like Zumba, yoga, and boot camps to activate the space. ¹⁴	Limitation: The success of this model is heavily reliant on significant initial investment and the establishment of strong community partnerships for programming, which may not be replicable in all municipalities.	Opportunity: Demonstrates a highly effective solution to the "one-size-fits-all" failure by proving that a single park can successfully serve multiple, distinct user groups simultaneously through thoughtful, zoned design and active programming.
'Let's Go Southall' (UK)	A community-led "social movement" approach focused on empowering local residents to drive engagement and break down barriers to	Focused on the most inactive groups, including lower-income individuals, ethnic minorities, women, and older people. ⁶	Co-designed five state-of-the-art gyms with resident input. Trained 48 local "activators" to lead sessions and motivate the community. Installed smart screens with	Limitation: This model requires intensive, ongoing community engagement and management to train and support activators. Its long-term sustainability depends on	Opportunity: Represents a powerful shift from top-down provision to a bottom-up, co-produced solution. The "activator"

	physical activity. ⁶		free, localized classes featuring local people. ¹¹	maintaining volunteer momentum and community leadership.	model is a highly effective and scalable strategy for building trust, fostering social connection , and ensuring the program remains relevant to the community 's specific needs.
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2. Empathy Phase

2.1 User Interviews

(This section is reserved for the data you will collect through your Google Forms. You can insert the summaries of your three potential user interviews here.)

2.2 Empathy Map

This map synthesizes the perspectives of a composite persona—the "Hesitant Potential User"—who is motivated to be healthier but faces significant internal and external barriers. It captures their thoughts and feelings without reference to any specific solution.

SAYS <i>(What we hear them say out loud)</i>	THINKS <i>(What's on their mind, but unsaid)</i>
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"I should really get more exercise, but I don't have the time." ⁸	"I feel guilty that I'm not more active."
"Gym memberships are too expensive." ⁵	"Even if it's free, I'm not sure I belong there."
"I don't know how to use that equipment, I'm afraid I'll look stupid or hurt myself." ⁸	"Everyone else knows what they're doing. People are watching and judging me." ¹⁰
"There are always teenagers messing around on it, it doesn't feel welcoming." ¹⁰	"Is this space actually safe for me, especially in the evening?" ²⁰
"The equipment is always broken or dirty anyway." ¹¹	"No one seems to care about this place, so why should I?"
DOES (<i>What actions and behaviors do we observe</i>)	FEELS (<i>What are their emotions</i>)
Walks or drives past public parks but rarely stops to use the facilities. ¹⁰	Intimidated by the equipment and the social environment.
Sits on a park bench watching their children or grandchildren play. ²⁷	Anxious and self-conscious about their fitness level and appearance.
Chooses familiar activities like walking on a path over trying something new.	Motivated to improve their health but hesitant to start.
Avoids parks or certain areas after dark due to perceived safety risks. ²⁰	Frustrated with the lack of accessible, affordable, and welcoming options.
Tries to start a new routine but gives up after a short time due to lack of confidence or support.	Hopeful for a solution that feels safe, supportive, and non-judgmental.

3. Experimentation Phase

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